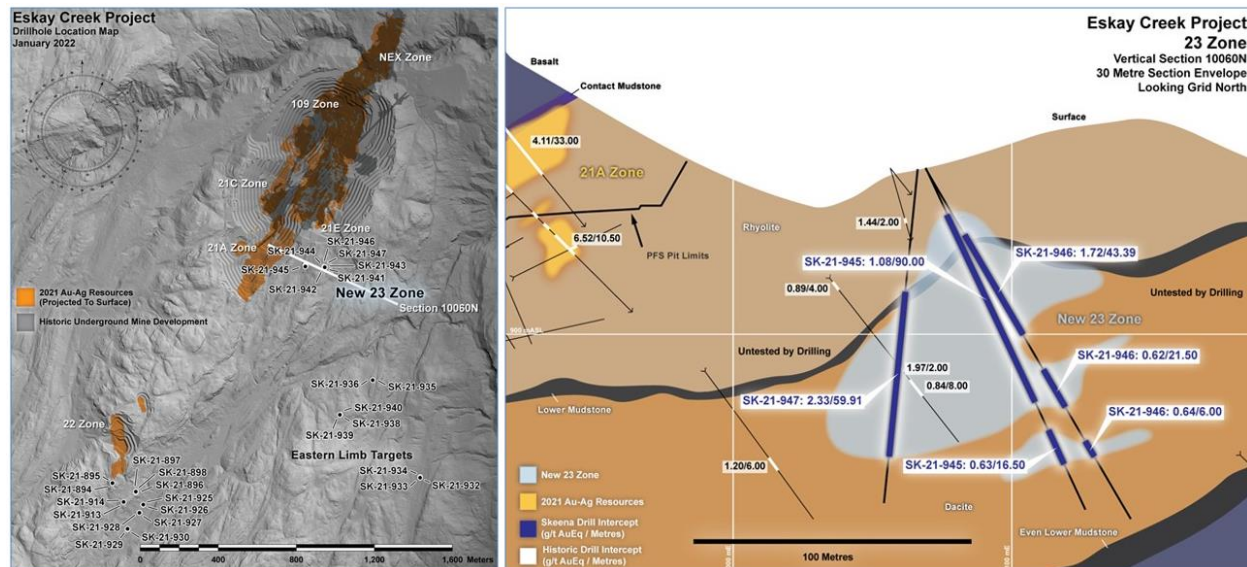


Ticker: SKE CN **Cash:** C\$74m **Project:** Eskay Creek
Market cap: C\$969m **Price:** C\$14.51/sh **Country:** Canada, BC
RECOMMEND. (unc): BUY **TARGET (unc):** C\$19.50/sh **RISK RATING:** HIGH

Today's 23 Zone results outside the MRE are impressive on both grade and width (i.e 59.9m @ 2.3g/t and 90m @ 1.1g/t) for solid new resource additions. Still, the core is the sweetest at 4-4.5g/t, so we think this likely fits later into the schedule. Important here is that these hits are only 15m deep for an ultra-low strip. Better still, the majority of today's hits are in the dacite host (good met), with minor portions in mudstone (bad met), but even then are noted to have low As/Hg (good met). Looking ahead, the remaining ~22,000m of drilling will be allocated to the Albino TSF in 2Q22, an area shaping up already to be ~2Mt @ 6g/t, which could drive ~385koz at zero strip (plus other TSFs around), a useful addition already ahead of more drilling. Looking forward, the critical catalyst here is drilling / DFS, working hand in hand to target LOM production approaching 400koz pa AuEq or more if satellites like this continue to deliver. Permitting could be a material catalyst also as Skeena has truly partnered with the Tahltan to the benefit of all parties. As such, we **maintain our 0.8xNAV multiple and C\$19.50/sh PT based** on 65% gearing, although given flexibility on anything from exploration spend to divestments and alternative financing such as silver streaming, this is only an approximation for now.

Figure 1. Eskay Creek project (A) plan map (B) 23 Zone x-section showing today's results



Source: Skeena

New 23 Zone returns 60m @ 2.3g/t AuEq near surface outside the MRE

Skeena reported **59.9m @ 2.3g/t** and **90m @ 1.1g/t** drilled at the new 23 Zone located outside the MRE only 15m vertically below surface, and **22m @ 3.5g/t AuEq** from the Even Lower Mudstone (ELM) ~200m SE of the 22 Zone and included narrower subintervals of **0.7m @ 59.9g/t AuEq** and **0.9m @ 19.7g/t AuEq**. To date, 12,890m has been drilled to date of the 35,000m program (~37%), with the balance being allocated to the Albino TSF in 2Q22. Separately on December 24th, Skeena closed a private placement and collected gross proceeds of C\$30.9m from selling 1.47 FT shares @ C\$21.00/sh to Franco-Nevada.

Why we like Skeena Resources

- Large high-grade open pit with SCPe >500koz upside potential in coming 12-18M
- Shift in market dynamics allows concentrate sales for lower capex
- Optionality from high-grade Snip mine nearby to blend concentrate or add ounces
- Catalyst heavy with drilling, metallurgy, PFS and DFS in coming 18M

Catalysts

- 1H22: Permitting update
- 1Q22: BFS including expanded resource
- 1H/2H22: AWF infill / expansion drilling

Research

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Ticker: SKE CN	Price / mkt cap: C\$14.51/sh, C\$969m	Project PNAV today: 0.62x	Asset: Eskay Creek / Snip
Author: B Salier/ B Gaspar	Rec / 0.8xNAV PT: BUY, C\$19.5/sh	1xNAV_{1Q22} FF FD: C\$23.39/sh	Country: Canada: BC

Commodity price	CY18A	CY19A	CY20A	CY21E	CY22E	Resource / Reserve	AuEq (koz)	AuEq (g/t)
Gold price	1,850	1,850	1,850	1,850	1,850	Pittable resource	5425koz	4.17g/t
SOTP project valuation*						Underground resource	224koz	5.41g/t
						Snip	646koz	13.60g/t

	C\$m	O/ship	NAVx	C\$/sh	Funding: uses	Funding: sources
Ungeared proj. @ build start (2Q22)	1,749	100%	1.00x	23.27	PFS capex	3Q21 cash + options* C\$74m
Net cash 3Q21 + Franco proceeds	74	100%	1.00x	0.98	SCPe G&A to 1st Au + ABX \$	Mine debt @ 65% gearing C\$291m
Cash from options	85	100%	1.00x	1.13	SCPe pre-production expl'n	Mine build equity at 0.6xNAV C\$235m
Eskay Ck resources ex reserve @US\$50/oz	88	100%	1.00x	1.16	SCPe finance costs + wkg cap	Total proceeds C\$600m
Snip (US\$75/oz)	62	100%	1.00x	0.82		Buffer C\$59m
Asset NAV5% C\$1850/oz	2,057			27.4	Total uses	C\$541m

*Shares diluted for options but not mine build

Market P/NAV5%, Q22 0.55x

*Cash from options expiring pre first pour

Asset value: 1xNPV project @ build start (C\$m, ungeared)*						Share data					
Project NPV (C\$m)*	\$1750oz	\$1850oz	\$1950oz	\$2050oz	\$2150oz	Basic shares (m)	66.8	FD with build equity raise	90.1		
10.0% discount	1,569	1,650	1,761	1,873	1,984	FD with options (m)	75.2				
7.5% discount	1,746	1,838	1,962	2,085	2,208	Ratio analysis					
5.0% discount	1,952	2,057	2,195	2,333	2,471						
Ungeared project IRR:	65%	66%	69%	73%	76%	Average shares out (m)	91.1	79.5	81.5	81.5	81.5
Project NPV (C\$m)*	\$1750oz	\$1850oz	\$1950oz	\$2050oz	\$2150oz	EPS (C\$/sh)	-	-	-	4.00	3.26
3.7g/t AuEq	1,620	1,746	1,871	1,963	2,087	CFPS (C\$/sh)	-	-	-	3.94	3.86
4.1g/t AuEq	1,952	2,057	2,195	2,333	2,471	EV (C\$m)	1,297.9	1,148.4	1,456.6	1,183.1	1,183.1
4.5g/t AuEq	2,249	2,401	2,552	2,703	2,854	FCF yield (%)	-	-	-	27%	27%
NPV5 (C\$m)*	\$1750oz	\$1850oz	\$1950oz	\$2050oz	\$2150oz	PER (x)	-	-	-	3.6x	4.5x
Payability: 67%	1,620	1,746	1,871	1,963	2,087	P/CF (x)	-	-	-	3.7x	3.8x
Payability: 75%	1,952	2,057	2,195	2,333	2,471	EV/EBITDA (x)	-	-	-	2.5x	2.3x
Payability: 82%	2,249	2,401	2,552	2,703	2,854	Income statement					

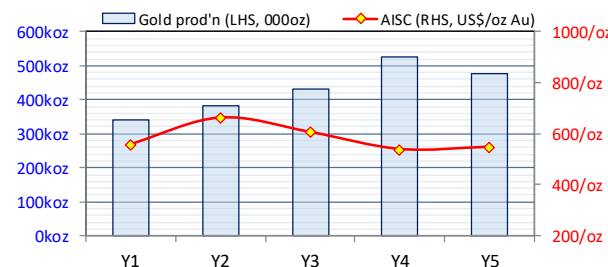
*Project level NPV, excl finance costs and central SGA, discounted to build start

Group valuation over time^	1Q22	1Q23	1Q24	1Q25	1Q26	D&A, attrib (C\$m)	0.2	-	-	54.2	62.4
Eskay Creek (C\$m)	1,749	2,086	2,451	2,205	1,959	Admin (C\$m)	20.8	16.0	16.0	16.0	16.0
Net cash prior qtr (C\$m)	26	7	(272)	49	364	Expensed exploration (C\$m)	92.1	15.0	-	-	-
G&A and finance costs (C\$m)	(163)	(145)	(130)	(102)	(78)	Finance cost (C\$m)	(0.2)	-	(4.6)	23.1	17.5
Cash from options (C\$m)	85	85	85	85	85	Royalty (C\$m)	-	-	-	12.3	13.8
Snip	62	62	62	62	62	Forex, other (C\$m)	(9.1)	-	-	-	-
NAV FF FD (C\$m)	1,758	2,094	2,196	2,300	2,391	Taxes (C\$m)	-	-	-	75.5	162.0
1xNAV _{5%} /sh FF FD (C\$/sh)	23.39^	27.85^	24.36*	25.51*	26.53*	Net income (C\$m)					
Equity ROI from spot (% pa)		92%	41%	33%	27%						
Geared company NAV diluted for mine build, net G&A and finance costs						Cash flow, attrib.					
2Q22 1xNAV FF FD (C\$/sh)^	\$1750oz	\$1850oz	\$1950oz	\$2050oz	\$2150oz						
10.0% discount	19.41	20.63	22.31	23.99	25.68	EBIT (C\$m)	(104.0)	(31.0)	(16.0)	425.0	445.2
7.5% discount	21.06	22.39	24.18	25.98	27.79	Add back D&A (C\$m)	0.2	-	-	54.2	62.4
5.0% discount	22.90	24.36	26.29	28.22	30.16	Less tax + net interest (C\$m)	(0.2)	-	(4.6)	98.6	179.5
Geared project IRR:	59%	60%	64%	67%	70%	Net change in wkg cap (C\$m)	(5.9)	-	-	(53.1)	(6.3)
2Q22 1xNAV FF FD (C\$/sh)^	\$1750oz	\$1850oz	\$1950oz	\$2050oz	\$2150oz	Add back other non-cash (C\$m)	3.7	6.5	6.5	6.5	6.5
Payability: 67%	18.20	19.94	21.67	22.95	24.68	Cash flow ops (C\$m)					
Payability: 75%	22.90	24.36	26.29	28.22	30.16						
Payability: 82%	27.13	29.26	31.39	33.53	35.67	PP&E - build + sust. (C\$m)	(8.1)	(229.3)	(258.7)	(12.6)	(14.0)
						PP&E - expl'n (C\$m)	(0.5)	-	(15.2)	-	-
						Cash flow inv. (C\$m)					

^Project NPV incl grp SG&A & fin. cost, +net cash; *diluted for mine build equity

Production	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5	Share issue (C\$m)	96.0	235.0	-	-	-
Gold production (000oz)	341	382	431	527	477	Proceeds from sale (C\$m)	5.0	-	-	-	-
C1 cost (US\$/oz)	511	618	565	504	511	Debt draw (repay) (C\$m)	-	97.1	194.1	-	(97.1)
AISC cost (US\$/oz)	559	666	608	540	549	Cash flow fin. (C\$m)					

AISC = C1 + ug sustaining capex, Y1 = 12M to Dec 2024



Source: SCP estimates

Balance sheet	CY21E	CY22E	CY23E	CY24E	CY25E
Cash (C\$m)	25.6	103.9	19.2	340.7	558.0
Acc rec., inv, prepaid (C\$m)	7.3	7.3	7.3	53.6	63.8
PP&E + other (C\$m)	101.0	330.4	604.3	562.7	514.2
Total assets (C\$m)	134.0	441.6	630.8	957.0	1,136.0
Debt (C\$m)	1.6	98.7	292.8	292.8	195.7
Accounts payable (C\$m)	16.7	16.7	16.7	10.0	13.7
Others (C\$m)	7.4	7.4	7.4	7.4	7.4
Total liabilities (C\$m)	25.7	122.7	316.9	310.1	216.8
Sh'hlds equity + wrnts (C\$m)	335.9	577.4	583.9	590.4	597.0
Retained eam'gs + rsvs (C\$m)	(227.6)	(258.6)	(270.0)	56.4	322.2
Liabilities + equity (C\$m)	134.0	441.6	630.8	957.0	1,136.0

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BUY:	50
HOLD:	0
SELL:	0
UNDER REVIEW:	0
TENDER:	1
NOT RATED:	0
TOTAL	51

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